

Free and Informed Consent Form (FICF)

This document, called the Free and Informed Consent Form (FICF), aims to ensure your rights as a participant and will be made available electronically.

Please read it carefully and calmly, seeking to fully understand the purpose of the research. There will be no penalty or harm if you do not wish to participate or if you withdraw your authorization at any time.

INFORMATION ABOUT THIS RESEARCH:

Objective: In this research, we seek to understand how developers treat data quality as a requirement in machine learning-based systems. Our objective is to identify adopted practices, challenges faced, and existing gaps in this area. We are also interested in investigating how these professionals perceive, prioritize, evaluate, and incorporate data quality characteristics, such as accuracy, consistency, completeness, reliability, timeliness, traceability, and compliance, throughout the development of these systems.

Importance of the study: This study aims to obtain valuable insights into how data quality requirements are considered in practice in machine learning-based systems. The results may contribute to identifying adopted practices, challenges faced, and existing gaps in data quality management, supporting improvements in Requirements Engineering, Software Engineering, and the development of machine learning-based systems.

Procedures and methodology: To participate in this research, you must be over 18 years old and have previously worked in software development for machine learning-based systems. Your participation consists of answering an online questionnaire about data quality requirements in this type of system, which will take approximately 15 minutes to complete. We guarantee the privacy and confidentiality of all information provided during the research.

Data treatment: Throughout the entire process, compliance with privacy and ethical standards will be ensured, as established by the Brazilian General Data Protection Law - LGPD, Law No. 13,709/2018 - guaranteeing that participants' information will be treated confidentially. The data collected through the online questionnaire will be anonymized by removing any information that could directly identify participants. The data will be organized and coded to facilitate analysis. The results will be presented in an aggregated and non-individually identifiable manner, thereby preserving participants' privacy in accordance with the applicable legal provisions.

Contact with the researchers: At any time, you may contact us to obtain information about this research project, your participation, or any other matter related to the study. The research team can be contacted through Kevin Pontes (kevinpontes@alu.ufc.br) and Anderson Uchôa (andersonuchoa@ufc.br).

GUARANTEES TO PARTICIPANTS:

Right to refuse participation: At any time, you may refuse to participate and withdraw from the research, without embarrassment, penalties, or any harm. The information and materials

obtained in this research will not be used for purposes other than those within the context of this study.

Confidentiality and privacy: We guarantee the full confidentiality and anonymity of your responses. All sensitive information, such as names of companies or other people, will be completely anonymized.

Responsibility of the Researcher: We ensure that this document will be provided to the research participant and that the data obtained will be used exclusively for the purposes described in this document or according to the consent given by the participant.